



Raquel Albuquerque Simões Baeta Mendes

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Experience

PHD AT UZH (UNIVERSITY OF ZURICH), ZURICH, CH – AUG 2020 TO JUL 2026

- PhD student in the Neuropharmacology group of the Institute of Pharmacology and Toxicology.
- Teaching 150h of undergraduate experimental classes. Organising yearly High School visits to our lab.
- Organising social events within the institute.

LIFE SCIENCE ZURICH YOUNG SCIENTISTS NETWORK (LSZYSN) MEMBER, ZURICH, CH – AUG 2020 TO MAY 2025

- Team leader of two 5-8 people teams; Board member in 2024, supporting and coordinating over 30 people.
- Organised several 5-7 events per year, as well as, yearly helped organise Switzerland's biggest Life Science Career Fair with over 30 companies and 1000 participants.

RESEARCH LAB TECHNICIAN AT IGC (GULBENKIAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE), OEIRAS, PT – MAR 2017 TO JUL 2020

- Main role of lab and mouse colony management. Assistance in research and instructing new members.
- Role as Research technician representative in the IGC community.

RESEARCH LABORATORY TECHNICIAN AT UOS (UNIVERSITY OF SUFFOLK), IPSWICH, UK – FEB 2016 TO MAR 2017

- Laboratory organisation and management, ordering reagents and materials, elaboration of COSHH sheets and SOPs
- Support of researchers and teachers, preparation and assistance in practical classes, teaching procedures to students.

Core Organisational Skills and Competences

- Excellent organisation and planning skills (gained through working in laboratory management, the LSZYSN and PhD)
- Good coordination ability (gained being a monitor in a Science Museum and during work with university staff at UOS)
- Ability to work in a group and integrating in a team or project (acquired while working on research projects in university, in IGC, in the LSZYSN and during the PhD).
- Good communication skills (gained through the work in different projects and environments, and living abroad)
- Capacity of integration in a different society and culture (gained through studying and living abroad).
- Leadership skills (obtained while working as a board member in LSZYSN)
- Good teaching and mentoring skills (gained through teaching assignments and tutoring)

Technical Skills and Competences

- Biochemistry and molecular biology techniques, Cell culture, Microscopy, working with animal models (specifically mice (Felasa B)), Laboratory organisation and management.

Talks and Conferences

Aug 2024 – Presenting a poster of my PhD work in the IASP conference in Vienna, Austria

2nd June 2019 – Presenting the work of the Obesity group in informal conversation related to the Brain exhibition, Gulbenkian Foundation, Lisbon, Portugal

31st May 2019 – Presiding as group representative and evaluator in the Bachelor thesis defense of Marco Freitas entitled "Investigation of the Physiological Role of Leptin in Thermoregulation", University Nova, Lisbon, Portugal

28th Oct 2017 – Presenting the work of the Obesity group in the 1st Lisbon International Lipedema Meeting, Lisbon, Portugal

Education

2013 - 2015 – Student of Masters in Biochemistry from the Department of Chemistry and Biochemistry of University of Porto, with a final grade of 17.4 over 20.

2012 - 2013 – Erasmus year in Biochemistry in the University of Dublin, Ireland.

2010 - 2013 – Biochemistry degree from Department of Biochemistry of University of Coimbra; final grade of 14.9 over 20.

Computer Skills and Competence

Microsoft Office™ tools (Word™, Excel™ and PowerPoint™), ImageJ (image processing), GraphPadPrism (graphing and statistical analysis), Blast tools from NCBI, Matlab.

Language Skills

Language	Understanding		Speaking		Writing	
Portuguese	C2	Native user	C2	Native user	C2	Native user
English*	C2	Proficient user	C2	Proficient user	C2	Proficient user
Spanish	A2	Basic user	A1	Basic user	A1	Basic user

* Certificated of Proficiency in English (CPE), from British Council School

Voluntary work

- Voluntary at Refood organisation (collects unwanted food from restaurants and redistributes to families in need)
- Voluntary at IGC: Open Days, high school 'Scientists for a day' program, NOS Alive music festival.

Hobbies

- Reading, cross-stitching, attending art events and going to museums, aerial yoga.